

Subject Code	ENGL5038
Subject Title	Introduction to English Linguistics
Credit Value	3
Level	5
Pre-requisite/ Co-requisite/ Exclusion	n/a
Objectives	This course aims firstly to familiarise students with the concepts, terminology, and methods of linguistic analysis in the context of English; secondly to familiarise them with the structures of the English language and the basic principles that underlie them; and thirdly to help them apply this knowledge to professional and/or educational contexts. After acquiring the concepts in this core course, students will be better prepared for more specialized courses that focus on phonetics/phonology, grammar, sociolinguistics, and corpus linguistics, as well as those that focus on language and communication in the workplace/classroom.
Intended Learning Outcomes	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: Category A: Professional/academic knowledge and skills - understand the International Phonetic Alphabet (IPA) and key principles of English phonology; - construct and deconstruct English words based on principles from morphology; - conceptualize common syntactic structures of English; - understand the diachronic and synchronic change of English lexis; - use corpora to investigate English lexis in use; - identify semantic properties of English words and phrases and understand semantic relationships between words; - apply the linguistic concepts learnt to the analysis of English in professional and/or educational contexts. Category B: Attributes for all-roundedness - learn to think like a linguist (i.e., beyond orthography and surface sentence structures); - display critical and creative thinking in reading; - develop a range of strategies for life-long learning through reading and computer research.
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus	Most/all of the following topics will be covered: - The properties of human language - Introductions to the following areas of English linguistic study: - phonetics (International Phonetic Alphabet, consonants, vowels, etc.) - phonology (phonemes, allophones, co-articulation effects, etc.) - morphology (morphemes, affixes, word formation, etc.)

Student Study Effort Expected	Other student study effort:	
	▪ Assessment preparation	37 Hrs.
	▪ Class preparation (including reading)	44 Hrs.
	Total student study effort	120 Hrs.
Reading List and References	Fromkin, V., Rodman, R., & Hyams, N. (2018). <i>An introduction to language</i> (11th ed.). Wadsworth. Kroeger, P. (2022). <i>Analyzing meaning: An introduction to semantics and pragmatics</i>. Language Science Press. Lakoff, G., & Johnson, M. (1980). <i>Metaphors we live by</i>. University of Chicago Press. O'Keefe, A., & McCarthy, M. (Eds.). (2022). <i>The Routledge handbook of corpus linguistics</i> (2nd ed.). Routledge. Yule, G. (2017). <i>The study of language</i> (7th ed.). Cambridge University Press.	

Revised by Scott Daly in April 2026